

# MUSIC

## OVERVIEW

Music study at the Grade 9 and 10 level is intended to develop students' understanding and appreciation of music through a focus on practical skills and creative work. Students will find in music a source of enjoyment and personal satisfaction and will gain creative problem-solving skills, individual and cooperative work habits, knowledge of themselves and others, a sense of personal responsibility, and connections to their communities and future careers.

Students develop their awareness of the elements of music (pitch – melody, harmony, and tonality; duration – beat, metre, rhythm, and tempo; dynamics and other expressive controls; timbre; texture; and form) and apply them to create and perform works that are related to their personal interest and experience. Students also refer to the elements of music when reviewing, evaluating, and reflecting and commenting on their own and others' creative work.

Performance technique and an understanding of theory are of major importance for music students and are repeated in the expectations for both courses. Through informal presentations and more formal performances, students not only develop their technique but also use music to communicate their aesthetic and personal values. By experiencing, analysing, and commenting on the performances of others, students enhance their understanding of the values of other musicians and cultures.

The expectations for music courses are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Creative work involves the practical application of skills and knowledge of theory as they relate to performance and composition. Students will perform, individually and in ensembles (e.g., using voice, band instruments, string instruments, guitar, keyboards, or other performance media). They will perform notated or improvised music and compose or arrange music, demonstrating technical skills and applying current digital technologies where appropriate.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** Using the critical analysis process (see pages 16–20) to analyse and reflect on different types of music enables students to develop a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. Analysis involves listening to live or recorded performances from a range of cultures to understand the language of music, its historical and cultural context, and how effectively its composers and performers communicate to their audience. Students also explore how music reflects and affects the societies in which it was created.

3. **Foundations:** This strand involves learning the symbols, concepts, and conventions used in music. Students also develop the vocabulary necessary for discussing and evaluating music. This foundational study helps them understand and appreciate different musical forms as well as ethical issues and musical etiquette.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 11–12 of this document.

The list of approved focus courses for Music can be found at:

[www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html](http://www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html).

# Music, Grade 9

Open

AMU10

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This course emphasizes the creation and performance of music at a level consistent with previous experience and is aimed at developing technique, sensitivity, and imagination. Students will develop musical literacy skills by using the creative and critical analysis processes in composition, performance, and a range of reflective and analytical activities. Students will develop an understanding of the conventions and elements of music and of safe practices related to music, and will develop a variety of skills transferable to other areas of their life.

**Prerequisite:** None

# A. CREATING AND PERFORMING

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the stages of the creative process when performing notated and/or improvised music and composing and/or arranging music;
- A2. The Elements of Music:** apply elements of music when performing notated and improvised music and composing and/or arranging music;
- A3. Techniques and Technologies:** use a variety of techniques and technological tools when performing music and composing and/or arranging music.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** apply the creative process when performing notated and/or improvised music (*e.g., explore variations in and make artistic decisions about tempo, dynamics, and phrasing and related aspects of articulation; experiment with a variety of possible responses in a call-and-response activity; perform music for a partner, and reflect on his or her feedback in order to refine aspects of their performance*)

**Teacher prompts:** “How do you decide whether your experiments with dynamics or other expressive changes have been successful?”  
“In what ways did feedback from your peers influence how you have refined your performance of this piece of music?”

- A1.2** apply the creative process when composing and/or arranging music (*e.g., use the applicable steps of the creative process when arranging an existing melody for performance on their instrument or when creating a simple composition for available percussion instruments; explore sounds from the human-created or natural environment as possible inspiration for a musical composition; refine their composition/arrangement on the basis of peer- and self-assessment*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What might you use as an inspiration for your melody?” “Why is it important to build in time for experimentation and revision as you prepare your composition for performance?”

### A2. The Elements of Music

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** apply the elements of music and related concepts appropriately when interpreting and performing notated music (*e.g., accurately play or sing notated articulations such as slurs, accents, staccato; play or sing repertoire with accurate pitch and intonation; play or sing maintaining a consistent tempo; accurately interpret dynamic intensities as indicated in notated musical phrases; play or sing with tone colour appropriate to the repertoire*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Are the elements of pitch and duration equally important in your performance of this selection? Why or why not?”  
“Which aspect of the element of duration is more important to the success of your performance of this selection, tempo or rhythm? Why?”

- A2.2** manipulate the elements of music and related concepts appropriately when improvising melodies and rhythms (*e.g., when practising rhythmic call-and-response patterns and scales; when improvising melodies and rhythms using diatonic and pentatonic patterns; when improvising simple two-bar call-and-response melodies and rhythms; when improvising simple four-bar diatonic melodies over accompaniments generated by accompaniment software and representing a variety of accompaniment styles*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Which elements are easiest for you to work with when you are improvising?” “What role does accompaniment play in your improvisation?”

**A2.3** apply the elements of music and related concepts appropriately when composing and/or arranging simple pieces of music (e.g., *when writing a four-bar rhythm pattern that could be used as the basis for a composition; when writing a simple diatonic melody over a prescribed harmonic progression; when creating a simple composition using melody and rhythm in binary form*)

**Teacher prompt:** “When you are composing, do you approach rhythm or melody first? What aspect of the composition do you approach next? Why?”

### A3. Techniques and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

**A3.1** demonstrate technical skill when performing notated and/or improvised music (e.g., *perform a sixteen-bar melody using proper bow or finger technique; correctly perform articulations when sight-reading a piece of music; play a wind instrument or sing with suitable breath control*)

**Teacher prompts:** “In what ways does proper breathing support successful performance? Where are the best spots to breathe in this selection?” “What musical information do you need to consider prior to attempting to sight-read a piece?”

**A3.2** apply compositional techniques when composing and/or arranging simple pieces of music (e.g., *compose a simple melody with an effective melodic shape; arrange selected melodies to reflect specific musical forms*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What is the most important characteristic of your melody? Why?” “Why is it important for your melody to have contour?” “How might you revise your melody to create a different shape or line?” “What revisions might you make to the melodic shape or line to make your melody more effective?”

**A3.3** use current technology when practising, performing, composing, and/or arranging music (e.g., *use available technology to record their performance or composition for self-assessment or to record a performance for evaluation; use notation software when composing simple melodies; perform with accompaniment software*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What is the most effective way of recording a performance you wish to assess?” “Which functions in your music software are similar to those in other software programs, such as word processing programs?” “What effect does changing the style in your accompaniment program have on your performance?”

## B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process when responding to, analysing, reflecting on, and interpreting music;
- B2. Music and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how traditional, commercial, and art music reflect the society in which they were created and how they have affected communities or cultures;
- B3. Skills and Personal Growth:** demonstrate an understanding of how performing, creating, and critically analysing music has affected their skills and personal development;
- B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** identify and describe various opportunities for continued engagement in music.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** listen to selections that represent a variety of musical styles and genres, and identify and reflect on their personal responses to them (*e.g., their initial reaction to an in-class performance by their peers; their favourite contemporary commercial music groups and the aspects of this music that they enjoy; their favourite parts of their band repertoire and what they like about them; the influence of specific pieces, styles, or genres on their arrangements or performance*)

**Teacher prompt:** “Why does this piece of music appeal to you? Has it influenced the way you approach your own compositions, arrangements, or performances? Why or why not?”

- B1.2** identify and describe the use of elements and other components of music in a variety of selections, including their performance repertoire (*e.g., describe melodic characteristics, rhythmic components, signs and symbols, dynamics, and timbres in the print version of a choral selection before hearing the selection; describe how elements are used for expressive purposes in an arrangement being performed by the class, and how changes in these elements might alter the expressive qualities of the performance; describe technical aspects of a professional performance*)

**Teacher prompts:** “How has the composer manipulated the elements of music to create changes in the ‘feel’ of this selection?” “How would you characterize the mood of this work, based on the tempo and style markings?”

- B1.3** describe the difference between technical aspects and expressive aspects of music, with particular emphasis on shaping musical phrases and choosing appropriate tempo, and assess the contribution of both aspects to the successful interpretation of musical selections (*e.g., demonstrate both technical and expressive characteristics when interpreting music in performance; address both technical and expressive characteristics when analysing musical performances*)

**Teacher prompt:** “What is the relationship between technical skill and artistry in the interpretation of music? Have you ever heard or performed a piece that was lacking in one of these areas? What effect did this have on the performance? How could the imbalance have been corrected?”

- B1.4** conduct research to gather reliable information relating to specific music, musicians, and the musical opinions of others, and describe the impact this information has had on their own opinions or assessments (*e.g., listen to, read about, and discuss with their peers a selection of music by a contemporary artist or group; assess*

*the reliability of the judgements expressed in their sources; describe how a particular source has influenced their opinions and/or why a different source has not influenced them)*

**Teacher prompts:** “Based on information obtained from your research, what have you learned about the quality of this group’s musical output and the nature of its members’ careers?” “What range of opinions did you find among audience members with respect to last week’s lunch-time recital? Did their insights influence your opinion of the recital? Why or why not?” “Which types of sources have had the greatest impact on your opinion about this composer? Why?”

## B2. Music and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

**B2.1** identify and describe ways in which traditional music reflects the society in which it was created and how it has affected communities or cultures (*e.g., the Celtic influence on East Coast fiddle music as a reflection of historical immigration patterns to Canada, and how this music has contributed to the local community; the focus of the music in ceremonies and celebrations of some of Canada’s Aboriginal peoples; how instruments and scale patterns used in traditional Chinese music contributed to the creation and preservation of a distinct musical style in China*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Why do many Canadian folk songs have French origins? What do these songs tell us about the lives of people who immigrated to Canada?” “Why are First Nation musical ceremonies and celebrations often connected to aspects of nature? What do these themes tell us about the Aboriginal societies in question?”

**B2.2** identify and describe ways in which commercial music reflects the society in which it was created and how it has affected communities or cultures (*e.g., Big Band and other popular music during World War II as a source of support for the troops; the inspiration for the Seattle Grunge scene in the 1990s and its cultural impact; the links between reggae and Rastafarianism*)

**Teacher prompt:** “What are some features of anti-establishment peace songs written in North America in the 1960s and 1970s? In what ways do these features reflect aspects of North American culture, or counterculture, at the time?”

**B2.3** identify and describe ways in which art music reflects the society in which it was created and how it has affected that culture or community (*e.g., the impact of religious practices on the art music of different cultures, including various Asian cultures; the impact of availability of materials on the musical instruments developed by various cultures; the influence of Mozart’s patrons on the composer’s operatic work, and the impact Mozart had on changing the way opera was perceived*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What impact did the patronage system in Europe have on the development of the Western canon of art music? In what ways did this system reflect the class structure at the time?” “What are the distinguishing characteristics of art music in Chinese culture?” “In what ways do developments in contemporary art music reflect the preoccupations of the present generation?”

## B3. Skills and Personal Growth

By the end of this course, students will:

**B3.1** identify and describe how the study of music has contributed to their personal growth (including the development of their values), their ability to express themselves, their awareness of the aural world around them (both human-created and natural), and their awareness of others (*e.g., how expressing themselves through performing or creating music has affected their self-awareness; how musical study has affected their appreciation of the aesthetic value of the sounds of nature and their awareness of people from other communities or cultures*)

**Teacher prompts:** “In what ways has your ability to express an idea or emotion through a musical composition contributed to your self-awareness?” “What has the discipline associated with regular musical practice taught you?”

**B3.2** describe the development of their musical skills and knowledge, and identify the main areas they will focus on for improvement (*e.g., use journals and reflective practice logs as means of self-assessment; listen to and reflect on their own work; reflect on the input of peers and/or the teacher; compare their performance to an exemplary performance to help them identify areas for improvement*)

**Teacher prompts:** “How does the tempo of your performance of this selection compare to that in an exemplary performance of the same

selection?" "What element of music seems to give you the most difficulty? What might you do to improve your skill with respect to that element?"

**B3.3** identify and describe some of the interpersonal skills and work habits that contribute to the successful completion of individual and collaborative musical tasks (*e.g., the importance of punctuality, active participation, and active-listening, team-building, and leadership skills when participating in ensembles; the importance of preparation and perseverance when working independently*)

**Teacher prompt:** "What character traits and interpersonal skills should individual participants display when part of an ensemble? Why?"

## B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

**B4.1** identify and describe a variety of work or career possibilities related to music study (*e.g., explore job websites; interview a freelance musician and report on his or her typical work week; identify the positions and track the responsibilities of all the people involved in the production and marketing of a commercial recording, including those involved in touring and publicity*)

**Teacher prompts:** "What are some of the benefits and drawbacks of pursuing a career in music?" "What sorts of activities might a freelance musician combine to make a living in the music field?"

**B4.2** identify and describe possible opportunities for continued musical study both in and out of school (*e.g., the secondary courses necessary to go on to music-related study at a college or university; music or arts camps/workshops, including those offered through the Ontario Educational Leadership Camp, that are available to Ontario students; ways to extend their music learning outside of the classroom, including private lessons, music clubs*)

**Teacher prompt:** "What courses are available in your community that would allow you to expand your study of music?"

**B4.3** identify opportunities for and explain the benefits of participating in co-curricular music activities and other arts activities in the school (*e.g., bands and/or choirs; opportunities to coordinate music for drama or dance presentations; opportunities related to arts activities outside of music, such as decoration, design, or technical opportunities associated with school events*)

**Teacher prompts:** "In what ways might participating in a school play, concert, or other arts presentation enhance your musical performance ability?" "How do you feel when you know a close friend or family member is in the audience for your performance?"

# C. FOUNDATIONS

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Theory and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of music theory with respect to concepts of notation and the elements and other components of music, and use appropriate terminology relating to them;
- C2. Characteristics and Development of Music:** demonstrate an understanding of the history of some musical forms and of characteristics of types of music from around the world;
- C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices and performance conventions relating to music.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### C1. Theory and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the elements of music, particularly through practical application and aural recognition, and use appropriate terminology related to these elements (*e.g., describe scales and scale patterns, and perform them with appropriate dynamic contrasts and articulation and varied rhythms; describe the main characteristics of a variety of styles of music with reference to their use of elements, and use accompaniment software programs to demonstrate them; identify the elements of music in a range of aural samples; use correct terminology to describe the elements of music in a selection they are preparing for performance; identify and describe various textures in music [monophonic, homophonic, polyphonic]*)
- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of, and use proper terminology when referring to, fundamental concepts associated with notation (*e.g., identify notes of the grand staff; identify and describe the meaning of signs and symbols; notate scale patterns; identify and demonstrate their understanding of varied tempo and expressive markings in the music in their repertoire; describe the cycle of fifths; transpose a vocal line from another range into their voice range*)
- C1.3** reproduce or identify accurately, from notation and/or listening, simple melodic, rhythmic, and harmonic examples (*e.g., accurately play or*

*sing notated rhythm patterns at sight; identify simple sound layering and voicings in aural samples; identify given intervals in a major scale from aural samples, and notate the intervals; identify major or minor tonality in examples and/or repertoire)*

### C2. Characteristics and Development of Music

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of the origins and development of some musical forms (*e.g., identify composers within a particular genre and situate them on a timeline; describe the development of music associated with rituals and ceremonies in various cultures*)  
*Teacher prompt:* "Why is it important to have an understanding of music history and cultural context when performing a new piece of repertoire?"
- C2.2** identify and describe shared and unique characteristics of types of music from around the world, including Aboriginal music (*e.g., the use of instruments in Aboriginal song; the ways digital sound is used in contemporary music; the use of dissonance in choral music from various cultures*)  
*Teacher prompts:* "What was unique about Mozart's operatic works?" "What are some ways in which a film score composer can engage a movie audience?"

### C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

**C3.1** identify and describe key physical and health considerations associated with practising, performing, and listening to music (*e.g., the correct body posture for playing their musical instrument; the function of the major muscles and the skeleton in performance situations; the importance of keeping their instrument clean and well maintained; the risks from exposure to loud sounds and the precautions necessary to protect hearing when performing or listening to loud music*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What are some of the main physical considerations that musicians should address in their daily practice and performance routines?” “Why is it important to have good posture when performing?”

**C3.2** demonstrate an understanding of conventions related to music performance, with reference to both performers and audience members (*e.g., demonstrate respect for others within the ensemble;*

*respond to non-verbal communication from the conductor’s podium; explain why the audience might applaud in the middle of a piece performed by a jazz quartet but not by a classical orchestra*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What differences might there be between the response of audiences at a classical concert and a rock concert?” “Why is it important that audience members turn off their cellphones and other electronic devices when attending a concert?”

**C3.3** identify ethical and legal responsibilities associated with music (*e.g., conduct a role play to illustrate responsibilities related to copyright law; brainstorm to develop a list of emerging forms of music distribution on the Internet and ethical and legal issues associated with them*)

**Teacher prompt:** “Do you use authorized sources when downloading music? Why is it important to do so?”